

Saturday, 1 August 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

26° 17°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

24° 14°

MANCHESTER

Drizzle

19° 13°

GLASGOW

Light rain

17° 12°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- The new Chancellor, Anneliese Healey, has announced the government's Budget will be held in October.**
Ms Healey also pledged to move money and power out of Westminster, and into every postcode around Britain. It's expected to be the first major fiscal event under the new administration.

POLITICS · UK

- A British man has been accused of spying on a Royal Air Force base in Cyprus for Iran.**
Rashad Sultanov, a UK-Azerbaijan national, was arrested on the island on suspicion of espionage at RAF Akrotiri. The base is a key strategic outpost for the UK.

DEFENCE · UK

- Aerial footage has revealed the extent of a wildfire tearing through heathland in Suffolk.**
The blaze has now grown to cover an area equivalent to more than 200 football pitches, according to Suffolk's fire service. Firefighters are continuing to battle the flames.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

- The boss of Thames Water has claimed that some of the company's leakage targets are 'not realistic'.**
Chris Weston admitted Thames Water wanted 'to do better' but suggested some targets were simply unachievable. The company has faced criticism over its performance.

ENVIRONMENT · UK

- A passenger on a British Airways flight that issued a Mayday distress call has described the fear on board.**
Edward Killiwick was on the flight that landed safely at Heathrow earlier this month. He recalled hearing shouts of 'I don't want to die' during the incident.

TRAVEL · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Glasgow is set to take centre stage in the latest Marvel cinematic universe film, 'Spider-Man: Brand New Day'.**

Scotland's largest city doubles as New York in the new instalment. Fans will be keen to spot familiar landmarks in the background.

ON AIR – Have you ever spotted your hometown in a movie, pretending to be somewhere else?

FILM · COMING UP
- 2 Former England football star Shaun Wright-Phillips has joined the line-up for the new series of 'Strictly Come Dancing'.**

The sportsman, son of Arsenal legend Ian Wright, played for clubs including Manchester City. He'll be swapping the pitch for the dancefloor.

ON AIR – Who would you love to see doing the Cha-Cha-Cha on Strictly this year?

TV · COMING UP
- 3 Ed Sheeran's foundation is expanding its work to the island of Ireland, which he's described as 'amazing'.**

The Ed Sheeran Foundation is initially funding 'North South Sounds 2026', bringing together 50 young musicians from Belfast and Cork. It aims to foster musical talent.

ON AIR – What's the best thing a celebrity has done for charity that really impressed you?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 4 The Mahrajan Festival is making its debut in London, celebrating Arabic culture and music.**

The festival features performances from artists like Saint Levant and Dystinct. Organisers hope it will be a 'milestone' for the Arabic community in the capital.

ON AIR – What's a new festival or event you're really looking forward to experiencing this year?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 5 The nominations for this year's Mercury Prize have been announced, with Olivia Dean among the contenders.**

The shortlist for the best album includes several returning nominees. However, Lily Allen notably missed out on a nod this year.

ON AIR – Who do you think deserves to win the Mercury Prize this year?

MUSIC · COMING UP

On the schedule

1

The new Scottish Premiership season kicks off on Friday, with fans wondering if anyone can challenge Celtic and Rangers.

Last term, Heart of Midlothian were the closest challengers to the Old Firm. All eyes will be on the opening fixtures to see who starts strong.

ON AIR – Do you think any team can break the Celtic and Rangers dominance in Scotland this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

2

Katie Boulter will lead the Great Britain team at the Billie Jean King Cup finals in China this September.

Boulter has been in impressive form recently and will be a key player for the British squad. They will compete in Shenzhen.

ON AIR – Who are you backing to bring home the silverware for Great Britain in tennis this year?

TENNIS · UK

3

Young British golfers Lottie Woad and Charley Hull featured in the best shots from day one of the AIG Women's Open.

The prestigious tournament is being held at Royal Lytham & St. Anne's. Both players showed their class with some impressive moments.

ON AIR – Who's your favourite British golfer to watch in action?

GOLF · UK

4

Southern Brave have maintained their unbeaten run in the women's Hundred, securing their fourth win in four games.

They beat Birmingham Phoenix by 24 runs at the Utilita Bowl. The Brave are looking like strong contenders for the title.

ON AIR – Are you following the Hundred this year, and which team are you rooting for?

CRICKET · UK

5

England rugby star Jamie George is swapping sports to help tackle Motor Neurone Disease.

The Saracens hooker and Somerset cricketer Lewis Gregory are playing a charity cricket match. They aim to raise money for MND charities.

ON AIR – What's the most inspiring charity event you've seen a sportsperson take part in?

RUGBY · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new trend sees people embracing 'upcycled fashion' by transforming old clothes into stylish new outfits.**
Fashionistas are finding joy and creativity in customising pre-loved garments, giving them a unique flair and extending their lifecycle. It's a wonderful way to be sustainable and express personal style.
- 2 The simple art of 'doodling' is being recognised for its surprising cognitive benefits.**
Research suggests that those seemingly idle sketches can actually help improve concentration, memory, and creative problem-solving. So next time you're in a meeting, don't feel guilty about that little drawing!
- 3 There's a growing appreciation for the quiet charm of 'canal boat holidays' as a way to unwind.**
Swapping bustling streets for tranquil waterways, families and couples are discovering the joy of slow travel, navigating Britain's scenic canals and experiencing a unique sense of peace.
- 4 The comforting ritual of 'making your own bread' is seeing a delightful resurgence in kitchens across the country.**
From rustic sourdoughs to simple loaves, home bakers are finding immense satisfaction in the aroma and taste of freshly baked bread. It's a truly wholesome activity that brings warmth to any home.
- 5 Gardeners are increasingly turning to 'native wildflowers' to boost local biodiversity.**
Planting species that naturally thrive in the UK not only creates beautiful displays but also provides vital habitats and food sources for local pollinators like bees and butterflies, enriching our ecosystems.
- 6 The satisfying hobby of 'jigsaw puzzles' is proving to be a popular stress-buster for adults.**
Stepping away from screens and engaging with a tangible challenge, many are rediscovering the calm focus that comes from piecing together an intricate image. It's a lovely way to unwind and feel accomplished.
- 7 An increasing number of people are discovering the simple pleasure of 'foraging for wild berries and edibles' in local hedgerows and woodlands.**
With a keen eye and responsible approach, enthusiasts are enjoying the thrill of finding natural treasures like blackberries, elderflowers, and wild garlic, turning them into delicious homemade treats.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to reach something on a high shelf, even if it doesn't really help?

ANSWER: STRETCHING OUT OUR NECK AS FAR AS IT CAN GO, AS IF THAT EXTRA INCH WILL MAKE ALL THE DIFFERENCE!

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before enjoying a lovely, hot cup of coffee. What is it?

ANSWER: SWIRLING THE MUG AROUND A FEW TIMES, EVEN IF IT'S PERFECTLY MIXED, JUST BECAUSE IT FEELS RIGHT!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes a particular 'song on the radio' just instantly makes you feel incredibly happy or brings back a fantastic memory?

We're wondering, what's that one song that's guaranteed to put a smile on your face, and what lovely memory does it conjure up for you?

- Think about those 'little everyday inventions' that you absolutely couldn't live without, even if they seem insignificant to others.

What's an often-overlooked item in your home or daily life that you genuinely cherish for making things so much easier or more pleasant?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** A group of owls is called a 'parliament'. This charming collective noun is thought to have originated from the perception of owls as wise and solemn creatures.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Butterflies taste with their antennae, which are covered in tiny chemoreceptors that can detect the chemical makeup of flowers and leaves.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The world's quietest room is located at Microsoft's headquarters in Redmond, Washington, and it's so quiet you can hear your own heartbeat.
- The 'unicorn' is the national animal of Scotland, symbolising purity, innocence, and power.
- Strawberries are the only fruit that wear their seeds on the outside, with an average berry having around 200 seeds.
- The Great Wall of China is not a continuous wall, but a collection of walls and fortifications built across different dynasties.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- The 'humble' carrot was originally purple, not orange, and was selectively bred to be orange in the 17th century by Dutch growers.
- The national anthem of Spain has no lyrics, making it one of only four in the world.

On this day

Day 213 of the year, 152 days left in 2026. Today Armed Forces Day (Lebanon); Armed Forces Day (China) or Anniversary of the Founding of the People's Liberation Army (People's Republic of China); Azerbaijani Language and Alphabet Day (Azerbaijan); Emancipation Day is commemorated in many parts of the former British Empire, which marks the day the Slavery Abolition Act 1833 came into effect which abolished chattel slavery in the British Empire: Emancipation Day is a public holiday in Barbados, Bermuda, Guyana, Jamaica, Saint Vincent and the Grenadines, Trinidad and Tobago. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1957 — Taylor Negron, American actor and screenwriter (died 2015)
- 1978 — Chris Iwelumo, Scottish footballer
- 1989 — Tiffany Young, Korean American singer, songwriter, and actress
- 1933 — Dom DeLuise, American actor, singer, director, and producer (died 2009)
- 1993 — Leon Thomas III, American actor and singer
- 1936 — Laurie Taylor, English sociologist, radio host, and academic
- 1953 — Robert Cray, American blues singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1968 — Dan Donegan, American heavy metal guitarist and songwriter

THE DAY TODAY

- 1993 — The Great Mississippi and Missouri Rivers Flood of 1993 comes to a peak.
- 2004 — A supermarket fire kills 424 people and injures 360 others in Asunción, Paraguay.
- 1976 — Niki Lauda has a severe accident that almost claims his life at the German Grand Prix at Nürburgring.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1974 — Cyprus dispute: The United Nations Security Council authorizes the UNFICYP to create the "Green Line", dividing Cyprus into two zones.
- 1981 — MTV begins broadcasting in the United States and airs its first video, "Video Killed the Radio Star" by The Buggles.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1960 — Dahomey (later renamed Benin) declares independence from France.

- 1960 — Islamabad is declared the federal capital of the Government of Pakistan.
- 1993 — The Great Mississippi and Missouri Rivers Flood of 1993 comes to a peak.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 214 of the year, 151 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Ahudemme (Syriac Orthodox Church).; Christian feast day: Basil Fool for Christ (Russian Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Ceferino Giménez Malla; Christian feast day: Centola and Helen. Star sign Leo, birthstone Peridot.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1939 — Wes Craven, American director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2015)
- 1962 — Lee Mavers, English singer, songwriter and guitarist
- 1932 — Peter O'Toole, British-Irish actor and producer (died 2013)
- 1962 — Cynthia Stevenson, American actress
- 1960 — David Yow, American singer-songwriter
- 1961 — Pete de Freitas, Trinidadian-British drummer and producer (died 1989)
- 1982 — Kerry Rhodes, American football player
- 1955 — Butch Vig, American drummer, songwriter, and record producer

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1943 — The Holocaust: Jewish prisoners stage a revolt at Treblinka, one of the deadliest of Nazi death camps where approximately 900,000 persons were murdered in less than 18 months.
- 1989 — Pakistan is re-admitted to the Commonwealth of Nations after having restored democracy for the first time since 1972.
- 1937 — The Marihuana Tax Act of 1937 is passed in America, the effect of which is to render marijuana and all its by-products illegal.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1947 — A British South American Airways Avro Lancastrian airliner crashes into a mountain during a flight from Buenos Aires, Argentina to Santiago, Chile. The wreckage would not be found until 1998.
- 1968 — An earthquake hits Casiguran, Aurora, Philippines killing more than 270 people and wounding 261.

Coming to cinemas

AUGUST 2026

FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

AUGUST 2026

W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)